class standard. However, where a category (5), (9) and (10) space, as defined in regulation 9.2.2.3, is on one side of the division, the standard may be reduced to "A-0". Where fuel oil tanks are below a special category space, the integrity of the deck between such spaces may be reduced to "A-0" standard.

5.1.2 Where a special category space or ro -ro space is sub divided with internal

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between such spaces may be reduced to "A-0" standard.
5.1.2 Where a special category space or ro -ro space is sub divided with internal
decks, the fire rating of these decks shall be determined based on the capacity and arrangement of the fixed water -based fire -extinguishing system. If the fixed water-based fire -extinguishing system cannot simultaneously cover the applicable area above and below a given deck, this deck shall be of "A -30" standard while any ramps and doors between decks shall be made of steel and of a design being as tight as practical.

5.2 Arrangement of openings in ro-ro spaces and special category spaces

5.2.1 Openings in the side plating, the ends or deckhead of the ro -ro space shall be situated and arranged so that a fire in the ro-ro space does not endanger:

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be situated and arranged so that a fire in the ro-ro space does not endanger:

.1 stowage areas for survival craft;

.2 embarkation stations and assembly stations, including access to such stations; and

.3 accommodation spaces, control stations and normally occupied service spaces in superstructures and deckhouses above the ro-ro space.

Openings are not permitted for all decks directly below these objects and within a safety distance of minimum 6.0 m measured horizontally.

5.2.2 This requirement does not apply to openings fitted with closing arrangements, such as ramps and doors. Ramps and doors shall be of steel for all decks directly below accommodation spaces, control stations and normally occupied service spaces, and minimum "A -0" for all dec ks directly below survival craft, embarkation stations and assembly stations.

5.2.3 Openings are, however, accepted in ro -ro spaces below accommodation

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embarkation stations and assembly stations.

5.2.3 Openings are, however, accepted in ro -ro spaces below accommodation spaces, control stations and normally occupied service spaces, when the fire integrity of the ship 's side, including windows and doors, is "A-60" on boundaries in a

rectangular area measured 6.0 m horizontally forward and aft of the openings and vertically minimum two deck levels above the deck level with the opening. "A-0" windows protected by a water -based system with an application rate of at least 5.0 L/min per square metre may be accepted as equivalent to "A-60" windows. Ventilation inlets shall be designed to minimize the risk of contamination.

5.2.4 Openings for mechanical ventilation of ro-ro and special category spaces are permitted below accommodation spaces, service spaces and control stations in superstructures, if the opening is protected by a closing device, with a closing

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superstructures, if the opening is protected by a closing device, with a closing arrangement not likely to be cut off in case of a fire in the ro -ro spaces, capable of being closed from a readily accessible position. The closing device shall be made of steel or other fire-resistant material. Such openings are not permitted below survival craft, the emergency generator and air intakes for the engine-room(s).

5.2.5 Notwithstanding the above, air intakes serving machinery used for the ship's main propulsion, power generation and emergency power generation shall be in a position minimizing the risk of being contaminated by a fire in the ro -ro space or special category space.

5.3 Arrangement of weather deck intended for the carriage of vehicles

5.3.1 Appropriate arrangements shall be made so that a fully developed fire on weather decks intended for the carriage of vehicles does not endanger:

.1 stowage areas for survival craft;

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weather decks intended for the carriage of vehicles does not endanger:
.1 stowage areas for survival craft;

.2 embarkation stations and assembly stations including access to these; and

.3 accommodation spaces, control stations and normally occupied service spaces in superstructures and deckhouses adjacent to the weather deck.

5.3.2 Appropriate arrangements shall be made providing a safety distance, measured horizontally, from the designated vehicle lanes of more than 6.0 m to accommodation spaces, control stations and normally occupied service spaces in superstructures and deckhouses adjacent to the weather deck.

5.3.3 The safety distance can be reduced to 3.0 m when boundaries, including windows and doors, within 6.0 m are of "A -60" integrity. Alternatively, "A -0"

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windows and doors, within 6.0 m are of "A -60" integrity. Alternatively, "A -0"

boundaries protected by a water -based system with an application rate of at least 5.0 L/min per square metre may be accepted as equivalent.
5.3.4 Survival craft and embarkation stations, including access to these, shall be protected with a safety distance of more than 12.0 m. Safety distances shall be measured horizontally.
5.3.5 Notwithstanding the above, air intakes serving machinery used for the ship's main propulsion, power generation and emergency power generation shall be in a position minimizing the risk of being contaminated by a fire on the weather deck intended for carriage of vehicles."
6 Fire extinction
6.1 Fixed fire-extinguishing systems
15 The explanatory paragraph under the title of existing section 6.1 (Fixed fire-extinguishing systems) is replaced by the following:
"(The requirements of paragraphs 6.1.1 and 6.1.2 shall apply to ships constructed on
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fire-extinguishing systems) is replaced by the following:
"(The requirements of paragraphs 6.1.1 and 6.1.2 shall apply to ships constructed on or after 1 July 2014. Ships constructed before 1 July 2014 shall comply with the previously applicable requirements of paragraphs 6.1.1 and 6.1.2. The requirements of paragraphs 6.2.1 and 6.2.2 shall apply to ro-ro passenger ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026. Passenger ships with vehicle, special category or ro-ro spaces constructed before 1 January 2026, including those constructed before 1 July 2012, shall comply with the requir ements of paragraph 6.2.3 not later than the first survey on or after 1 January 2028.)"
16 The following new section 6.2 is inserted after existing section 6.1 (Fixed fire-extinguishing systems) and the subsequent section (Portable fire extinguishers) and its paragraphs are renumbered accordingly:
"6.2 Fixed water -based fire -extinguishing system on weather decks
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paragraphs are renumbered accordingly:
"6.2 Fixed water -based fire -extinguishing system on weather decks intended for carriage of vehicles
6.2.1 In passenger ships, a fixed water-based fire-extinguishing system based on monitor(s) shall be installed in order to cover weather decks intended for the carriage of vehicles. The monitor(s) shall comply with the provisions of the Fire Safety Systems Code.
6.2.2 In passenger ships, drainage shall be provided where a fixed water -based fire-extinguishing system is installed to cover weather decks intended for carriage of vehicles. The system shall be sized to remove no less than 125% of the combined capacity of both the monitor(s) and the required number of fire hose nozzles.

6.2.3 For passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026 , including those
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6.2.3 For passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026 , including those constructed before 1 July 2012, a fixed water-based fire-extinguishing system based on monitor(s) shall be installed in order to protect areas on weather decks intended for the carriage of vehicles. Monitors shall be located in positions which ensure unobstructed protection of vehicles i n the area on the weather deck intended for carriage for vehicles, as far as practicable. Operation of monitors shall be ensured by safe access ways or remote control not to be impaired by a fire in the area protected by that monitor. Capacity of each monitor shall be at least 1,250 L/min. The Administration may permit lower flow rates when the required rate is not practical given the size and arrang ement of the ship. The Administration may also permit alternative arrangements for ships that have already installed a fixed water -based
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alternative arrangements for ships that have already installed a fixed water -based fire-extinguishing system based on monitor(s) prior to 1 January 2026."

17 Under the renumbered section 6.3 (Portable fire extinguishers), in the chapeau of the renumbered paragraph 6.3.2, the reference to paragraph "6.2.1" is replaced by "6.3.1" consequentially, as follows:

"6.3 Portable fire extinguishers

6.3.2 In addition to the provision of paragraph 6.3.1, the following fire-extinguishing appliances shall be provided in vehicle, ro -ro and special category spaces intended for the carriage of motor vehicles with fuel in their tanks for their own propulsion: "

18 The following new section 7 is added after existing section 6 (Fire extinction):

"7 Decision-making

(The requirements of paragraph 7 shall apply to passenger ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026.)

In passenger ships, vehicle, special category and ro-ro spaces, where fixed pressure
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after 1 January 2026.)

In passenger ships, vehicle, special category and ro-ro spaces, where fixed pressure water-spraying systems are fitted, shall be provided with suitable signage and